

HTTP Status Codes

How to interpret HTTP responses in API testing.

Overview

HTTP codes are grouped into 1xx informational, 2xx success, 3xx redirection, 4xx client error and 5xx server error.

Essential QA codes

Validate 200, 201 and 204 for success; 400, 401, 403, 404, 409, 422 and 429 for client scenarios; and 500, 502, 503 and 504 for server/dependency failures.

Test strategy

Do not validate the number alone. Check body, headers, contract, business rules, idempotency and sensitive-data exposure.

When to use it

Use this knowledge when product risk, architecture or the delivery stage requires this type of validation. Confirm the goal, environment, required data and expected evidence before starting.

How QA applies it

Start from the behavior or risk to validate, prepare data and environment, execute the technique or tool reproducibly and capture evidence that helps the team understand the result.

Good practices

Prioritize high-impact scenarios, keep data and environments controlled, record important decisions and review the approach periodically to avoid redundant or outdated coverage.

QA tip

Always connect the practice to product risk and the evidence needed for quality decisions.

Official resources

Site oficial: <https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/HTTP/Reference/Status>